

Navigating the sands of time

Ubisoft India is spearheading the new Prince of Persia: Sands of Time remake and we sit down with the folks who made it possible.

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Mithun: Ubisoft has Anvil, Disrupt, Dunia and Snowdrop as in-house/co-developed game engines. What were the key reasons for picking Anvil?



Sashi Menon,
Production Director

Sashi Menon

(Ubisoft): Yes, you are right and we have a number of in-house engines at Ubisoft and we performed several thorough evaluations before deciding which game

engine to go forward with. The reasons why we chose Anvil is that the kind of features and the kind of gameplay that Anvil supports was the closest to what we wanted with the Prince of Persia game. It's important to highlight that this doesn't mean that the game that we are developing is going to be along the lines of Assassin's Creed or it's going to follow Assassin's Creed. It's a separate game with a separate art direction, mechanics, universe and so on. It was the closest to what we wanted in an engine and that's all.

Mithun: Could you elaborate on that with a few specific examples?

Sashi Menon (Ubisoft): For example,

the lighting environment that we have in Anvil is very close to what we needed to simulate Persia and India, so that's one of the reasons. Then there's the gameplay, if we were to look at the Snowdrop engine, then it's very shooter-oriented. In Assassin's Creed where it's going to involve a lot of close-quarters hand-combat the Anvil engine had the closest feature set.



Annu Koul,
Senior Producer

Annu Koul

(Ubisoft): Just to add to that. It was also the camera and the controls which are very important for this game. This engine gave us an opportunity to enhance it very well.

Mithun: Each of Ubisoft's studios have certain strengths that Ubisoft leverages across their IPs. What would you say are the key strengths of the Mumbai and Pune offices?



Syed Abbas,
Deputy Managing Director

Syed Abbas

(Ubisoft): For this game particularly, it's been two years now that we've been working closely between Pune and Mumbai. And you know that our Mumbai office opened two

years ago. With this approach in mind, we wanted to have speciality and a specific approach for both the studios to work as one team because at the end of the day, even though it's two studios, it's going to be one team that works on the game. In Mumbai specifically, we were focusing on the art and the content direction. And in Pune, we were leveraging on our expertise that we've been building for

the past 10 years in terms of technology, which is a strong asset and key strength. As well as design capabilities. It was a mix of these things and we were working as a team with the two offices specialising in these aforementioned areas.

Mithun: You mentioned that it took 10 years to lay the foundation that made the Prince of Persia remake happen. How long do you believe until Ubisoft Pune and Mumbai can develop the first AAA original IP?



Jean-Philippe Pieuchot,
Managing Director

Jean-Philippe Pieuchot

(Ubisoft): We believe that 10 years is not that long because it's a very competitive market where only the best of the best can execute this. It's a very big

challenge to grow and reach each of the milestones along the way. This is an industry which sees a lot of innovations and it sees plenty of disruptive technologies. Making a game requires various expertise across different domains which is something we can obtain from all our global studios and we also make it a point to be part of a game with other studios. We're in a framework of collaboration at Ubisoft and we're very glad to work with other studios. It's true that it's a dream for our teams to develop our own IP but I think everyone is now very mature and have understood that it takes many years and many more milestones to achieve before we get to that step. It is possible that one day we will do that but it is impossible to set a time frame on that. I'm super confident that we have the right team in India to continue to scale up and we'll demonstrate it very well in this game that's coming up. 🚀